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IMPACT OF BRAND IMAGE ON CONSUMER BUYING INTENTIONS

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ABSTRACT:

The consumer's attitude towards the brand is extremely important in their buying process in highly competitive market. It is even more important in garment industry, where clothing not only is a functional item, but is symbolic in identity, status and is used for individual representation. The following research paper on impact of brand reputation on the consumer behaviour shows the behaviour of consumer through the example from the residents of Raipur. The following research uses primary and secondary data which makes it descriptive. We collected primary data through questionnaires from different age group and secondary data from past research, academic journals and books. The research shoes that he buying intentions is directly related to the brand image. The clothing brands were taken into considerations and consumers relate them with branded clothing items and higher social status and self-respect. Even the factors such as price and convenience do play a slighter role but less impactful. Thus, in conclusion, the consumer choice is directly impacted by the brand image aligning it with psychological factors and economic influences.

Keywords: Brand Image, Consumer Behavior, Purchase Intent, Clothing Industry, Brand Perception.

1. Introduction

The contemporary competitive and dynamic environment of the market place exposes the consumers of the products that the subjects offer them with the plethora of options. They therefore, rely on decision making cues particularly those which are related to brand image in order to facilitate decision making process. The brand image being the set of the perception, beliefs and associations that consumers hold about a brand proves to be a great determinant of the purchasing behaviour (Aaker, 1997; Keller, 2003).

The impactful brand reputation can influence companies to be unique in competitive markets since it can cultivate more credibility and present consumers with opportunities to make superior judgments concerning the products. A good awareness and perception of a brand mean that consumers will mostly choose that brand over others that they are unfamiliar with (Kotler and Keller, 2016). Brand image is also a psychological short cut, which reduces uncertainty, and reduces the decision-making process. Conversely, customers will not purchase the product due to a bad image of the brand, in essence will deter customer loyalty Islam, T., & Hussain, M. (2023). Purchase intention is a scale of the likelihood of a particular consumer buying a particular product at a specific time in the future. It is influenced by several factors which include attitude, social factors, quality perceptions and past experiences Khoirunnisa, D., & Albari, A. (2023). Brand image among them plays a very significant role in such industries such as clothing where functional attributes are not the most decisive factors that govern the decisions made by consumers but also the emotional and societal factors (Wu and Wang, 2014).

In case of branded clothing, people's lifestyle and increase in purchasing power or income, in the case of Raipur city, plays a crucial role in telling choice of the consumer. The consumer looks more into social status, confidence and self-identity instead of comfort, design, quality, etc. Majorly the youth is more influenced by the goodwill of the brand making them more brand conscious, its design which reflect their social status more. (Hossain et al., 2020)

2. Literature Review

A series of studies has explored brand image and consumer behavior, highlighting insights from Khoirunnisa, D., & Albari, A. (2023). brand image included various associations that consumers have with a brand that they retain in their minds. Certain associations plays a significant role in make them influence more in context of their point of view and seeing the products according to their mind set. Keller(2002) states that the brand reputations is build through the experience gained by the consumer and the advertisement which attracts them like word of mouth. This research identified the brand loyalty as a

determining factor making the repeat purchase. The loyal customers themselves are insensitive to the price and will refer to other individuals to the brand.

Another research conducted by Hossain et al. (2020) also found that the factor of social media is critical and creates an image of brand among younger customers. Positive Internet reviews and support of influencers may be very powerful in brand recognition.

Research Gap

Despite the popularity of brand image and consumer behaviour to have been widely researched, few research has been made in the local regions and in the individual industries. There are several studies carried out in the developed markets and there exists a gap in the understanding of the consumer behaviour in the emerging markets like India.

Moreover, there is very little study which involves a combination of different aspects of brand image in one test. This gap is attempted to be addressed in this paper by incorporating their various facets and looking at the impact thereof.

3. Research Design / Research Model

3.1 Research Design

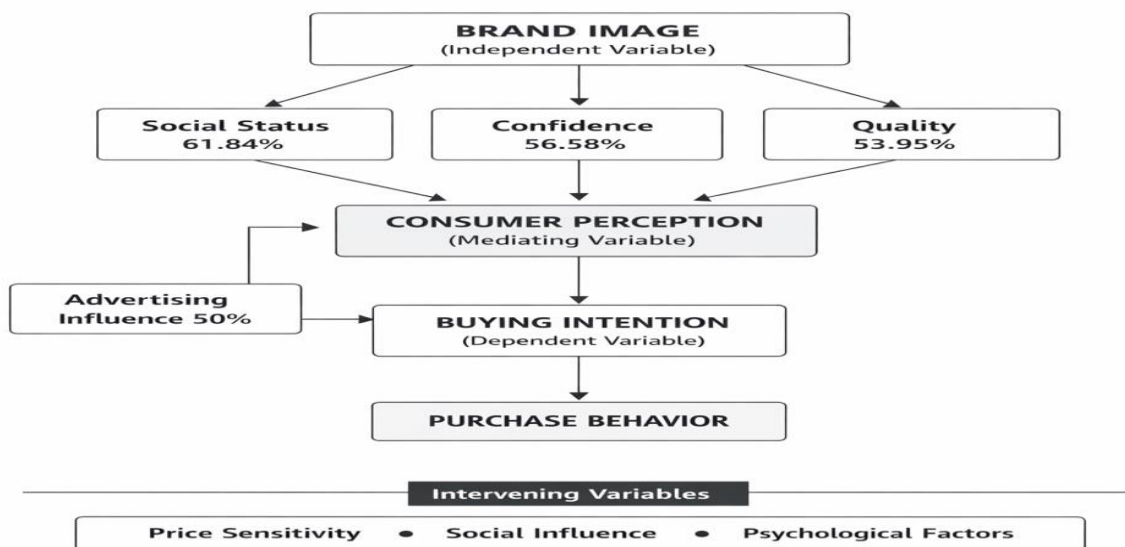
The present study has adopted quantitative, descriptive and cross-sectional research design for examining The influence of brand perception on consumers' purchase decision making in Raipur's clothing market.

This design is appropriate since it will allow for systematic measurement of consumer perceptions based on quantitative data and comparing them against important variables. This was a cross-sectional study as data was collected at a given point in time ($n = 76$).

It adopts empirical data (primary) and theoretical concepts (secondary) to ensure the soundness of analysis, as well as its usability.

3.2 Conceptual Framework (Research Model)

The paper relies on a multi-dimensional brand image model, in which the brand image influences consumers purchasing intention as a result of perceptual drivers.



Model Structure:

Brand Image (Independent Variable)

human → Consumer Perception (Mediating Layer) → Intention to buy (Dependent Variable)

3.3 Operationalization of Variables

Independent Variable: Brand Image, measured across four dimensions:

Dimension	Positive Responses	Percentage
Social Status	47 / 76	61.84%
Confidence	43 / 76	56.58%
Perceived Quality	41 / 76	53.95%
Advertising Influence	38 / 76	50.00%

Dependent Variable:

Consumer Buying Intention (through the level of agreement and expenditure)

Intervening Variables:

- Price sensitivity
- Social influence
- Psychological factors

3.4 Model Interpretation

The empirical model shows the following hierarchical impact of the brand image dimensions:

- Social Influence (61.84) Strongest driver.
- Psychological Influence (Confidence = 56.58%)
- Functional Influence (Quality = 53.95%)
- Promotional Influence (Advertising = 50.00%)

Key Insight:

The internal factors (Social Status (61.84%) & Confidence (56.58%)) have a much stronger influence than the external promotional influence (Advertising = 50%).

This affirms that emotional and social factors are the main determinants of consumer perception as opposed to the marketing exposure only.

3.5 Sampling and Data Structure.

Sample Size: 76 respondents

Observations in total: 304 (76 x 4 Likert variables)

Age Distribution:

- 18–25: 64 (83.12%)
- 26–35: 4 (5.26%)
- 36–45: 6 (7.89%)
- 45+: 2 (2.63%)

Spending Distribution:

- ₹1,001–₹3,000: 37 (48.68%)

- ₹3,001–₹5,000: 19 (25.00%)
- Above ₹5,000: 15 (19.74%)
- Below ₹1,000: 5 (6.58%)

Inference:

The model is mostly youth-led (83%), and mid-income consumer behaviour (~73.68), which indicates a high value-conscious branded consumer behaviour.

3.6 Hypothesis Model

The hypothesis testing with the model is applied in this section to test the hypothesis (H 2).

H1: Brand Image -Buying Intention (Supported)

H2: Perceived Quality (53.95) to Purchase Behaviour.

H3: Psychological (Confidence) Factor to Buying (56.58)

H4: Perception (relatively weaker) Advertising.

3.7 Justification of Research Design

The research design is justified as follows:

- Gives practical, objective data (n = 76, 304 observations)
- Allows the comparison of brand image dimensions.
- Observes actual consumer perception trends within a certain market (Raipur).
- Is in line with descriptive research objectives and theory-testing approach.

4. Research Methodology

The study will adopt a quantitative descriptive research design, to examine the impact of brand image on the consumers' buying decision in the apparel industry and in the context of the city Raipur. The approach will help us have some measurable understanding of consumer perception and behaviour.

The research follows a deductive approach where a group of theories of brand image, perceived quality, and consumer behaviour are being tested by using the data. This research is cross-sectional where the data is gathered at a single point in time and from a sample of 76 (n = 76).

4.1 Data Collection

The study will be founded on primary and secondary data:

Primary Data:

Gathered via a structured questionnaire based on 5 points Likert scale (1 to 5) and multiple choice.

- Total respondents: 76
- Measurement variables that are important: 4 (Social Status, Confidence, Quality, Advertising).
- Total Likert: $76 \times 4 = 304$ observations.

Secondary Data:

Obtained academic journals and research papers as well as marketing textbooks to show theoretical frameworks and prove the research results.

4.2 Sampling Design

- Sampling Technique: Convenience sampling.
- Target Population: Consumers of branded clothing in Raipur

Age Distribution:

- 18–25: 64 respondents (83.12%)
- 26–35: 4 respondents (5.26%)
- 36–45: 6 respondents (7.89%)
- 45+: 2 respondents (2.63%)

Spending on Clothing (monthly):

- ₹1,001–₹3,000: 37 respondents (48.68%)
- ₹3,001–₹5,000: 19 respondents (25.00%)
- Above ₹5,000: 15 respondents (19.74%)
- Below ₹1,000: 5 respondents (6.58%)

This implies that it is a youthful sample with the majority being mid-range spenders (~73.68%)

4.3 Variables

Independent Variable: Brand Image, which has four dimensions:

- Social Status: 47/76 respondents (61.84%)

- Confidence: 43/76 respondents (56.58%)
- Perceived Quality: 41/76 respondents (53.95%)
- Advertising Influence: 38/76 respondents (50.00%)

Dependent Variable: Consumer Buy intention.

Intervening Variables:

Sensitivity to price, social influence and psychological reasons.

4.4 Data Analysis Techniques

Descriptive statistical tools like those employed to analyse **Likert-scale** data were used in the study of the data obtained from **76 respondents (n = 76)**. They were chosen to appropriately summarise, describe, and compare consumers' views.

1. Frequency Distribution

The analysis involved categorisation of the responses and calculation of their frequency. Example:

- 43 out of 76 respondents expressed agreement regarding confidence in branded clothing.

This method helps in identifying the distribution pattern of responses.

2. Percentage Analysis

Nominating data was standardized to compare the impact by converting frequency into percentage:

$$\text{Percentage} = \left(\frac{\text{Frequency}}{76} \right) \times 100$$

Example:

- Confidence = $(43/76) \times 100 = 56.58\%$

This allows easy comparison across variables.

3. Mean Score Analysis

Since the study uses a **5-point Likert scale (1 = Strongly Disagree to 5 = Strongly Agree)**, mean scores were calculated to measure the average level of agreement.

$$\text{Mean} = \frac{\sum(f \times x)}{76}$$

Where:

- f = frequency of responses
- x = scale value (1–5)

This method helps in ranking factors based on their relative importance.

4. Weighted Average Method

The weighted average technique was used to assess the impact of each variable by allocating weights.

$$\text{Weighted Score} = \sum(f \times w)$$

Where:

- f = frequency
- w = weight (Likert scale value)

This provides a more precise measure by considering response intensity.

5. Comparative Analysis

Comparative analysis was employed to compare the variables and determine key influences on purchase intention

Example:

- Social Status (61.84%) has a greater influence than Advertising (50.00%)

6. Data Volume and Reliability

- Total respondents: **76**
- Variables measured: **4**
- Total observations: **$76 \times 4 = 304$**

The relatively large number of observations enhances the **reliability and consistency** of the findings.

4.6 Methodological Justification

The chosen methodology is appropriate as it provides data-driven and quantitative information, enables comparison of the variables, and represents the patterns of consumer behaviours in the selected sample.

4.7 Ethical Considerations

The research is conducted in accordance with the ethics for the research quality. Consent to participate in the survey was sought with an explanation of the study before data collection commenced. Consent was sought and received from survey participants. The respondents' confidentiality and anonymity were ensured and no personal information was collected or revealed. The responses were solely utilised for academic and research purposes, and not disclosed to third parties. The researcher also made sure the questions were not biased and that there was no manipulation or psychological coercion of the participants. The responses were accurately documented and interpreted without manipulation.

4.8 Study limitations.

In spite of valuable information, there are some limitations of the study that should be considered:

Small Sample Size: The research is conducted on 76 respondents which may not be representative of the whole population.

Convenience Sampling: The sampling is not probability, which limits the generality of the results.

Geographical Limitations: The study is limited to Raipur and therefore might not be applicable to other areas where there are variations in consumer behaviour.

Industry-Specific Focus: The study is restricted to the clothing industry and it might not be representative of the trends in other industries.

Self-reported Data: The answers are provided according to individual perceptions and they might be biased or inaccurate.

Cross-Sectional Nature: Data were measured at one time and therefore, no changes in consumer behaviour over time are measured.

5. Data Analysis and Results

5.1 Introduction

Data analysis (n = 76) of frequency distribution and percentage table with comparative analysis was used. It aims to find out the trends in consumer perception and to study the effect of branding perception on the consumer purchasing decision in the apparel industry.

5.2 Demographic Analysis

Age Distribution

18–25 years: 64 respondents (83.12%)

26–35 years: 4 respondents (5.19%)

36–45 years: 6 respondents (7.79%)

45+ years: 2 respondents (2.60%)

Age Group	Respondents	Percentage (%)
18–25	64	83.12%
26–35	4	5.19%
36–45	6	7.79%
45+	2	2.60%
Total	76	100%

Interpretation

The majority (83.12%) of the consumers in the survey are between 18 to 25 years which means that young consumers have a significant impact. The group is highly affected by the fashion, social media and branding activity. But in contrast the size of the older consumer is only 10.39% (both 36+ age group combined) so a reduced influence is prominent in the low experience-based buyer behaviour.

Insight: Brand Image is more influential in youth markets.

5.3 Spending Behaviour Analysis

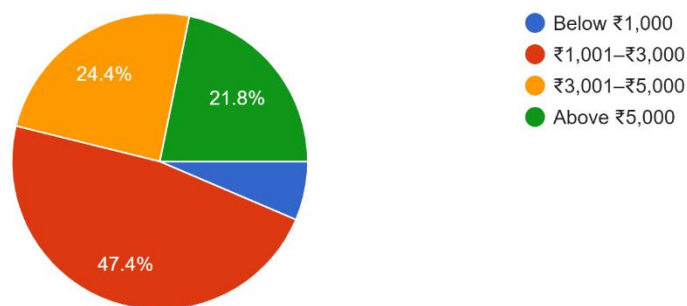
- ₹1,001–₹3,000: 37 respondents (48.05%)
- ₹3,001–₹5,000: 19 respondents (24.68%)
- Above ₹5,000: 15 respondents (19.48%)
- Below ₹1,000: 5 respondents (6.49%)

Spending Range	Respondents	Percentage (%)
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Below ₹1,000	5	6.49%
₹1,001–₹3,000	37	48.05%
₹3,001–₹5,000	19	24.68%
Above ₹5,000	15	19.48%
Total	76	100%

What is your average spend per clothing item?

78 responses



Interpretation:

The middle-income group (**₹1000–₹5000**) also has a concentration of population around this middle-income band which would translate to a large population of shoppers (72.73%.) The lowest spending is at 6.49% which indicates that the majority of respondents are not reluctant to spend on apparel (including branded apparel).

Comparative Insight:

The middle-income (**₹1000–₹5000**) is more than 11 times the low one suggesting a tendency of switching to a more value-oriented brand consumption.

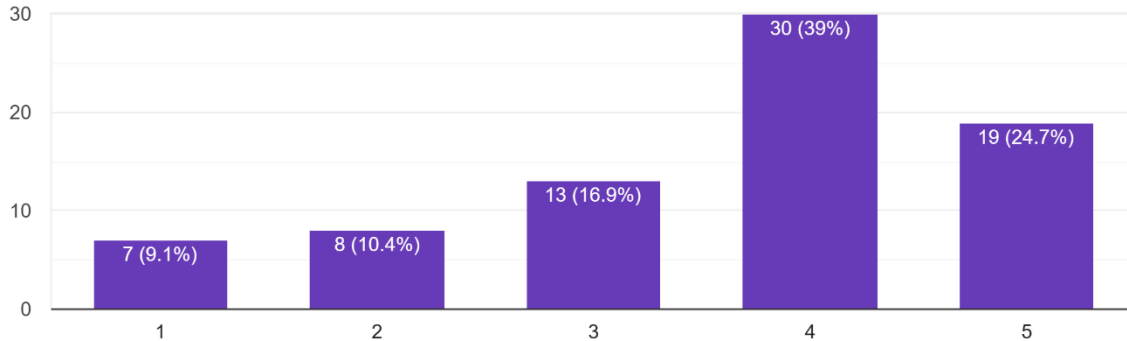
5.4 Brand Image and Social Status

Response	Frequency
Strongly Disagree	7
Disagree	8
Neutral	13
Agree	28

Strongly Agree	19
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I perceive branded clothing as a symbol of high social status.

77 responses



Numerical Breakdown

- Positive (Agree + Strongly Agree): 47 interviewees (61.84%)
- Neutral: 13 respondents (17.11%)
- Negative (Disagree + Strongly Disagree): 15 (19.74%)

Interpretation

There is an evident majority (61.84%) who think that branded garments augment social status, 3 times higher than the negative (19.74) responses.

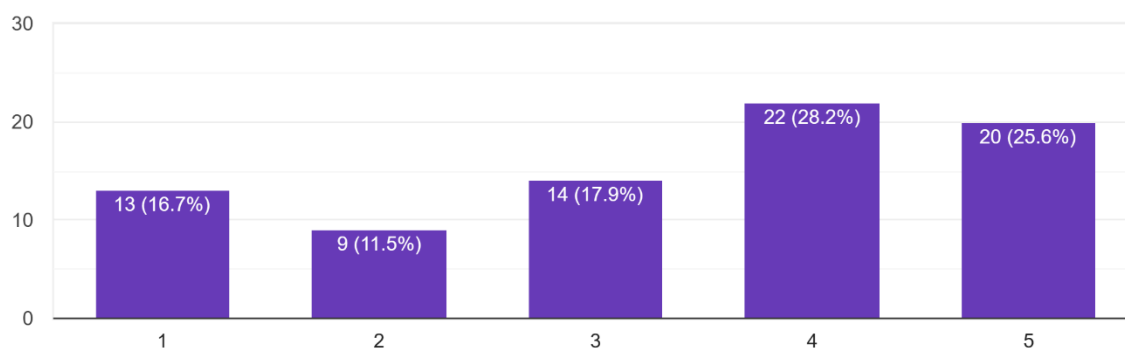
Insight: Brands image is a status symbol particularly in conspicuous product types such as clothing.

5.5 Perceived Quality of Branded Clothing

Response	Frequency
Strongly Disagree	13
Disagree	9
Neutral	13
Agree	22
Strongly Agree	19

I believe branded clothes offer superior quality and durability compared to unbranded ones.

78 responses



Numerical Breakdown

- Positive: 41 respondents (53.95%)
- Neutral: 13 respondents (17.11%)
- Negative: 22 respondents (28.95%)

Interpretation

Over half (53.95) of them view branded clothing as being of a better quality. Nonetheless, quality perception is a little lower than social status perception (61.84%), which indicates that the symbolic value might override functional value among some consumers.

Comparative Insight:

Status indicator of brand image is stronger than the quality perception by a factor of ~8%.

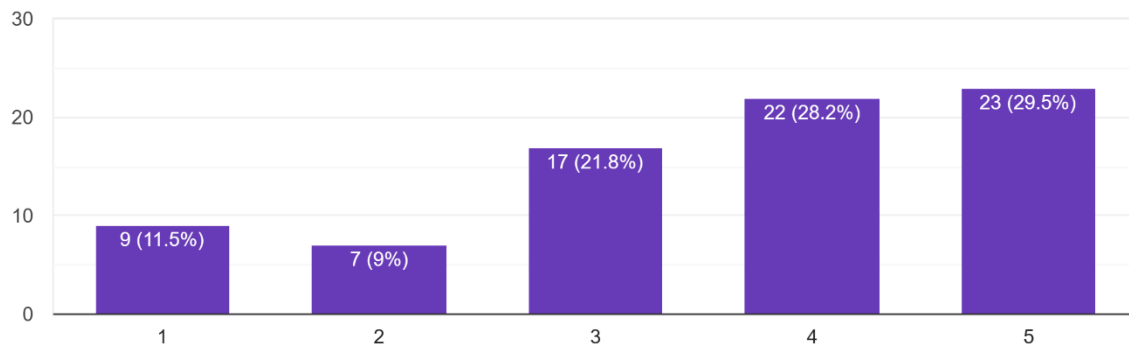
5.6 Psychological Impact (Confidence Level)

Response	Frequency
Strongly Disagree	9
Disagree	7

Neutral	17
Agree	20
Strongly Agree	23

I feel more confident when wearing clothes from a well-known brand.

78 responses



Numerical Breakdown

- Positive: 43 respondents (56.58%)
- Neutral: 17 respondents (22.37%)
- Negative: 16 respondents (21.05%)

Interpretation

Most of them (56.58%) are more confident in branded lounge. This is much more than negative responses (21.05%), which suggests a strong association psychologically.

Information:

The emotional payoffs (confidence), are almost as strong as social status and more stable than quality perception.

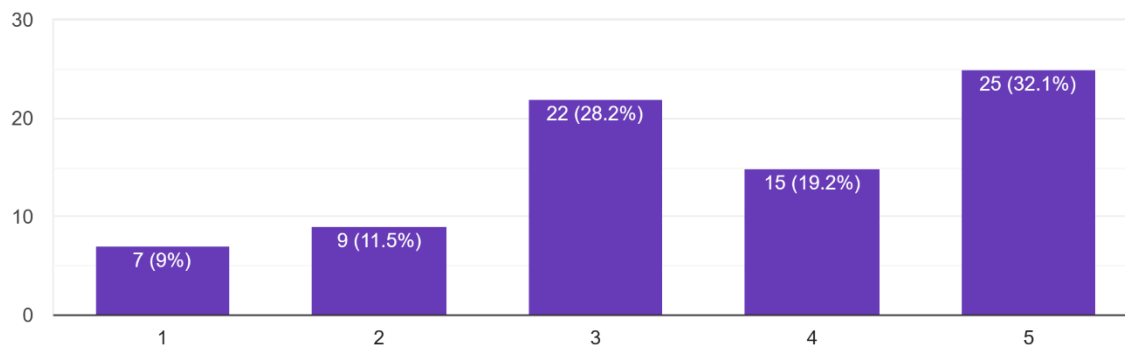
5.7 Advertising and Celebrity Influence

Response	Frequency
Strongly Disagree	7
Disagree	9

Neutral	22
Agree	15
Strongly Agree	23

Advertising and celebrity endorsements significantly influence my perception of a brand.

78 responses



Numerical

Breakdown

- Positive: 38 respondents (50.00%)
- Neutral: 22 respondents (28.95%)
- Negative: 16 respondents (21.05%)

Interpretation

Advertising is the least influential factor among the ones that were examined, as only 50% of the respondents have experienced a beneficial impact. by advertising.

Comparative Insight:

- Social Status Influence: 61.84%
- Confidence Influence: 56.58%
- Quality Influence: 53.95%
- Advertising Influence: 50.00%

Conclusion: There are more internal perceptions (status, confidence) than external influence (advertising).

5.8 Cross-Factor Comparative Analysis

Factor	Positive Response (%)
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Social Status	61.84%
Confidence	56.58%
Quality	53.95%
Advertising	50.00%

Interpretation

- Most Significant: Social Status.
- Second: Confidence
- Third: Quality
- Lowest: Advertising

This indicates that psychological and social factors prevail over promotional factors in the determination of the buying behaviour.

5.9 Key Analytical Findings

1.Brand Image as Social Identity:

Status is the strongest influencing factor with more than 60 percent of the respondents' associating brands with status.

2.Influence of emotion is powerful:

Confidence (56.58) demonstrates that emotional benefits are a big driver of purchase.

3.Quality is Not Primary but Secondary:

Although 53.95 value quality, it is not as important as psychological factors.

4.Moderate Impact of advertising:

Advertising will have an effect on awareness, but not always on the final decision as it received only 50% positive response.

5.10 Overall Conclusion from Data Analysis

Overall, our analysis of the data revealed that:

The numerical results show that the impact of brand image on the purchase intentions of consumers is very significant, but takes place via multiple channels:

Social influence (61.84%) > Psychological (56.58%) > Functional (53.95%) > Promotional (50%)

This hierarchy shows that identity and emotions play a larger role than pure rational motives in encouraging consumers.

Variable	Observation	Impact
Brand Image	Strong positive perception	High influence on buying intention
Quality	Majority agree it is superior	Key decision factor
Confidence	High agreement	Strong psychological impact
Advertising	Moderate to strong influence	Shapes perception
Spending	Mostly mid-range	Indicates value-conscious consumers

6. Future Scope and Conclusion.

6.1 Conclusion

The role of brand image in consumer purchasing intentions within the clothing industry in Raipur has been discussed in this paper. The results show that a strange influence has been witnessed on consumer behaviour by having brand image in terms of quality, reliability and trust on the branded clothes. This reduces the perception of risk and increases the confidence in decision to buy.

Due to social factor and psychological factors matters do tell about the significant role played by the brand reputation. Branded clothing is considered as the important part for showing their social status mostly by the young consumers. It highly shows how these consumers choose such brand to talk more about their social status and building confidence while using those products. While for quality purpose the respondents did agree and highly agreed towards confidence. Saying that psychological weightage was more. A little bit of advertising and family influence also affected and gave same results and topic of

discussions. But these are still not enough for brand image. In total, that emotional aspects and certain functional aspects do play a role in the brand image scenario for making purchasing intentions.

6.2 Managerial Implications

The companies should be interested in establishing a good brand image and quality products. Younger consumers need to be targeted with the help of digital marketing and social media, and influencer marketing should be applied to get appealing to the brand. The pricing policies should have capability to create a balance between the brand value and affordability so that it attracts a wider audience.

6.3 Future Scope

The research can be further expanded into new areas and use more advanced statistical techniques to interpret the data. It may be elaborated with comparative studies on different sorts of brands and shopping, the effect of social media and psychology. The research conducted over the long term can help in the perception of the changing consumer behaviours.

6.4 Limitations

The study has limitations;

- It has limited sample size,
- convenience sampling,
- self-reported data and clothing data that can affect the accuracy.

6.5 Final Remark

The brand image is a significant determinant of consumer buying decisions. Quality and price are also important but emotional and social values are also critical. An intermediate stance between branding, quality, and customer experience is essential to success in the long-term.

Annexure

- Which of the following clothing stores/brands in Raipur do you visit frequently?
- I perceive branded clothing as a symbol of high social status.
- I believe branded clothes offer superior quality and durability compared to unbranded ones.
- I feel more confident when wearing clothes from a well-known brand.
- I associate specific brands in Raipur with "modernity" and "latest fashion."
- Advertising and celebrity endorsements significantly influence my perception of a brand.
- When buying clothes in Raipur, how important is Brand Reputation?

- When buying clothes in Raipur, how important Price/Discounts?
- When buying clothes in Raipur, how important is store allocation?
- When buying clothes in Raipur, how important is peer influence / family recommendations?
- When buying clothes in Raipur, how important is product quality and comfort?
- How often do you shop for clothes?
- Do you prefer shopping at [standalone brand showrooms](#) (like Puma or Manyavar) or [multi-brand retail stores](#) (like Shoppers Stop or Central)?
- What is your average spending per clothing item?

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